and, therefore, on funds that can be spared for economic development and social welfare, is not hard to imagine.

Hanging a person is a process which does not take beyond ten minutes. The aftermath of such a hanging might be devastatingly long and enormously costly. The crowd thirsty for Afzal's blood is, thus viewed, the biggest enemy of the country.

This essay first appeared in the *Telegraph*, 10 November 2006.